SIMPLIHUMAN

2026 Operating Plan

Budget, Team, Marketing, Equity & Product Roadmap

$850K	18 mo	50K
Seed Round Target	Runway Target	User Target (Y1)

Prepared: March 2026 | For Co-Founders Only

CURRENT STATE

Where We Are: Honest Assessment

High satisfaction but low indispensability. We acquire interest but fail to convert it into habits. This plan addresses every gap.

What's Working

- **Mood Tracking** — 31-33% stable engagement
- **Satisfaction** — 70% rate 4-5 stars
- **Tier-1 Shift** — USA now #1 acquisition source
- **Global Reach** — 30+ countries, 9,206 verified users
- **851 opt-ins** — Contactable user base for re-engagement

What's Broken

- **70% onboarding drop** — 44% lost pre-Home
- **PMF only 25%** — Need 40%+ benchmark
- **Tier-1 churn** — Paid users cancel immediately
- **Echo 0% engagement** — Feature is dead
- **AI Chat 1.45% usage** — Paywall kills adoption

2026 Targets

- **Onboarding drop** → <20% (from 70%)
- **D7 retention** → 5-6% (from ~2%)
- **First mood log rate** → 50%+ (from ~30%)
- **PMF score** → 40%+ (from 25%)
- **Active paid users** → 50+ in Tier-1

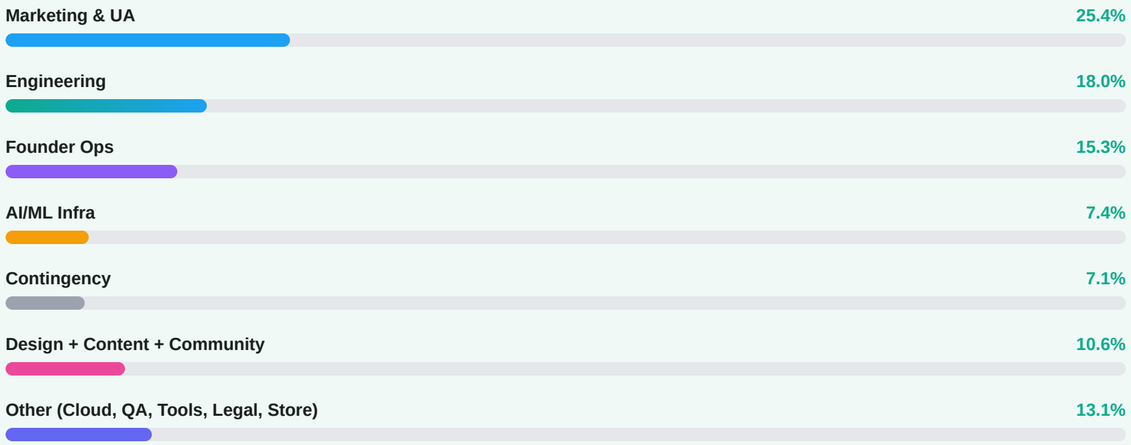
BUDGET

18-Month Budget: $850K Allocation

How we deploy capital from seed round + founder contributions to reach Series A readiness.

Category	Monthly	18-Month	% of Total
Engineering Team	$8,500	$153,000	18.0%
Design (UI/UX)	$2,500	$45,000	5.3%
AI/ML Infrastructure	$3,500	$63,000	7.4%
Cloud & DevOps	$2,000	$36,000	4.2%
Marketing & UA	$12,000	$216,000	25.4%
Content & Community	$2,500	$45,000	5.3%
Product & Analytics	$1,500	$27,000	3.2%
QA & Testing	$1,200	$21,600	2.5%
Tools & Subscriptions	$1,500	$27,000	3.2%
Legal & Compliance	$1,000	$18,000	2.1%
App Store Fees (30%)	$500	$9,000	1.1%
Contingency Reserve	—	$60,000	7.1%
Founder Operating Costs	—	$130,000	15.3%
TOTAL	**~$37K/mo**	**$850,600**	**100%**

Budget Split (Visual)



Why Marketing Gets 25%

Product fixes (Q1-Q2) mean marketing spend ramps in Q3+. Early months = $5K/mo. Post-PMF months = $18K/mo. Blended avg = $12K/mo. We fix the funnel first, then pour fuel.

Pakistan Cost Advantage

Full engineering team (3 devs + 1 QA + 1 designer) costs ~$12K/mo in Pakistan vs ~$60K/mo for equivalent US team. **5x cost efficiency** extends runway significantly.

TEAM

Team Build Plan: Pakistan-Based Operations

Lean, high-output team leveraging Pakistan's deep tech talent pool at 70-80% cost savings vs Western markets.

Hiring Plan — Salaries (PKR-based, shown in USD)

Role	Phase	Monthly USD	FTE
Sr. React Native Developer	Q1	$1,800–2,200	1
Mid React Native Developer	Q1	$1,200–1,500	1
Backend / API Developer	Q2	$1,500–2,000	1
AI/ML Engineer (NLP focus)	Q2	$2,000–2,800	1
QA / Test Engineer	Q1	$800–1,200	1
UI/UX Designer (Mid)	Q3	$1,000–1,500	1
Content Writer / Social Media	Q2	$600–900	1
Community Manager	Q3	$500–800	1
Data Analyst (Part-time)	Q3	$800–1,200	0.5
TOTAL TEAM		**$10.2–14.1K/mo**	**8.5**

Salaries based on Glassdoor PK, Rozee.pk, and LinkedIn PK market data 2025-2026. Ranges reflect experience bands.

Phased Hiring Timeline

Phase 1: Q1-Q2 2026 (Foundation)

Hire: Sr. RN Dev, Mid RN Dev, QA, Content Writer
Team cost: ~$4.5K-5.5K/mo
Focus: Fix onboarding, paywall, Mood 2.0, instrumentation

Phase 2: Q3 2026 (Growth)

Hire: Backend Dev, AI/ML Engineer
Team cost: ~$8K-10K/mo
Focus: AI personality system, analytics, performance optimization

Phase 3: Q4 2026+ (Scale)

Hire: UI/UX Designer, Community Manager, Data Analyst (PT)
Full team cost: ~$12K-14K/mo
Focus: Paid growth, community building, premium analytics

Cost Comparison: Pakistan vs USA

Role	Pakistan	USA	Saving
Sr. RN Dev	$2,000	$12,000	83%
AI/ML Engineer	$2,500	$15,000	83%
QA Engineer	$1,000	$7,000	86%
Content Writer	$750	$5,500	86%
Full Team (8.5 FTE)	**~$12K/mo**	**~$65K/mo**	**82%**

MARKETING

Marketing & User Acquisition: $216K / 18 Months

Fix the funnel first (Q1-Q2), then scale spend. Marketing ramps from $5K/mo to $18K/mo post-PMF validation.

CPI Benchmarks by Channel & Region

Channel	USA CPI	UK CPI	MENA CPI	S. Asia CPI
TikTok Ads	$1.50–3.00	$1.20–2.50	$0.80–1.50	$0.15–0.40
Instagram/Meta	$2.50–5.00	$2.00–4.00	$1.00–2.50	$0.20–0.60
Snapchat	$1.80–3.50	$1.50–3.00	$0.70–1.50	$0.10–0.30
Google UAC	$2.00–4.50	$1.80–3.50	$0.90–2.00	$0.15–0.50
Apple Search Ads	$2.50–5.50	$2.00–4.50	$1.20–3.00	$0.30–0.80

Sources: Liftoff 2025, Data.ai 2025, AppsFlyer Performance Index 2025. Health & wellness category averages.

Our Blended CPI Target

$1.80
Tier-1 Blended (USA, UK, MENA)

$0.30
Tier-2 Blended (S. Asia, N. Africa)

$1.10
Overall Blended Target

Channel Allocation Plan

TikTok Ads (Primary) — 35%
Lowest CPI for 17-28 demo. Video-first. Proven for wellness apps. ~$75K over 18mo.

Instagram/Meta Ads — 25%
Reels + Stories targeting. Strong MENA reach. Retargeting funnel. ~$54K over 18mo.

Influencer / Creator Partnerships — 20%
Micro-influencers (10K-100K followers) in wellness/Gen Z space. $200-$1K per creator. ~$43K over 18mo.

ASO + Google UAC + Apple Search — 15%
App Store Optimization + high-intent search ads. ~$32K over 18mo.

Community / Organic / PR — 5%
Reddit, university outreach, mental health awareness partnerships. ~$11K over 18mo.

MARKETING PHASING

Spend Ramp: Fix First, Scale Second

Marketing budget scales with product readiness. No point pouring money into a leaky funnel.

Period	Focus	Monthly Spend	CPI Target	Installs/mo
Q1 2026 Mar-May	Test & learn. Small TikTok + Instagram tests. ASO groundwork.	$3,000	$0.80	~3,750
Q2 2026 Jun-Aug	Ramp winners. Add influencer pilots. Launch ASA.	$8,000	$0.90	~8,900
Q3 2026 Sep-Nov	Post-PMF push. Scale TikTok. University partnerships.	$15,000	$1.10	~13,600
Q4 2026 Dec-Feb	Full scale. Multi-channel. Retargeting. Tier-1 focus.	$18,000	$1.20	~15,000
H1 2027 Mar-Aug	Optimize for LTV. Reduce CPI. Series A prep.	$16,000	$1.00	~16,000
18-MONTH TOTAL		**$216,000**	**$1.10 avg**	**~57,250**

57K paid installs + organic growth (currently ~500/mo) = ~66K total new users over 18 months. Combined with existing 9.2K base = ~75K total users. Exceeds 50K Y1 target in pitch deck.

Market Prioritization

Tier 1: USA, UK, Canada — 40%
Highest LTV ($8-15/user/yr). 40% of ad budget.

Tier 1B: UAE, Saudi, Qatar — 25%
High willingness to pay. English-speaking. 25% of ad budget.

Tier 2: Pakistan, India, Bangladesh — 20%
Ultra-low CPI. Volume for community/Echo. 20% of ad budget.

Tier 2B: EU, Australia, N. Africa — 15%
Test markets. Expand if CPI is favorable. 15% of ad budget.

Key Metric: LTV:CAC Ratio

Target LTV:CAC > 3:1 for Tier-1 markets. At $1.80 CPI and $10 ARPU, we need >54% of paid installs to convert to premium within 12 months. Currently unproven — this is what Q1-Q2 product fixes unlock.

EQUITY

Equity Structure: Resolving Sweat vs Cash

Two partners (Design Peeps at 10% and Ambeego at 5%) hold equity for work contributions. As cash-contributing co-founders invest, we need a fair framework to balance sweat equity vs cash equity.

The Core Problem

Double-counting risk: If a partner contributes both work (sweat) AND cash, they receive value twice for overlapping effort. Cash-only founders may feel shortchanged. Work-only partners may feel devalued if their equity dilutes with cash rounds.

Current Equity Positions

Partner	Equity %	Type	Contribution
Co-Founders (5)	85%	Cash + Sweat	Strategy, ops, clinical, design, tech + cash investment
Design Peeps	10%	Sweat Only	UI/UX design work (completed)
Ambeego	5%	Sweat Only	Development work (completed)

Industry Standard: Slicing Pie Model

Mike Moyer's **Slicing Pie** is the most widely-used framework for resolving this exact scenario in early-stage startups:

- **All contributions are converted to a single unit:** "slices"
- **Cash contributions** are valued at 2-4x multiplier (cash is riskier and more scarce)
- **Sweat contributions** are valued at fair market rate x time spent
- **Each person's equity = their slices / total slices**
- **Dynamic:** Equity adjusts as new contributions are made

Recommended Resolution Options

A Fixed Equity + Vesting (Recommended)

Honor the agreed 10% and 5% but subject to **4-year vesting with 1-year cliff**. Work already done counts toward cliff. If they stop contributing, unvested shares return to pool.

If they also invest cash: Cash buys additional shares from a new option pool at the current valuation — separate from sweat equity. No double-counting because sweat = past work, cash = new capital.

B Convert to Contractor + Reduced Equity

Retrospectively value their work at market rate (e.g., design work = $15K, dev work = $8K). Convert to: **reduced equity (e.g., 6% + 3%) + cash payment for remainder**. Clean break if they're not ongoing contributors.

C Slicing Pie Full Recalculation

Recalculate all equity from scratch using fair market rates for all contributions (time, cash, IP, assets). Most fair but most complex. Requires agreement from all parties on rates.

Key Principles (Any Option)

- **Cash gets a premium:** Industry standard is 2-4x multiplier on cash vs sweat (cash carries more risk and opportunity cost)
- **Vesting protects everyone:** Nobody walks away with equity for uncommitted future work
- **Ongoing work ≠ free:** Future design/dev work should be compensated separately (salary or additional equity grants), not assumed under original equity deal
- **Get it in writing:** Any resolution must be documented in a formal shareholders' agreement before the seed round closes

FOUNDER CAPITAL

Founder Cash Contributions: Pro-Rata Model

Co-founders contributing cash in proportion to their equity share. This maintains fairness and prevents dilution disputes.

How Pro-Rata Founder Investment Works

If total founder pool is 85% equity shared among 5 co-founders, and the group agrees to collectively invest (e.g., $100K pre-seed):

Founder	Equity Share*	Pro-Rata Cash
Founder A (if 25%)	25%	$29,400
Founder B (if 20%)	20%	$23,500
Founder C (if 15%)	15%	$17,600
Founder D (if 15%)	15%	$17,600
Founder E (if 10%)	10%	$11,800
Total	**85%**	**$100,000**

*Illustrative equity splits. Actual splits to be agreed by co-founders.

What If a Founder Can't Pay Pro-Rata?

Options: (1) Other founders cover the shortfall → they gain proportional equity from the shortfall founder's share. (2) Convert the gap to a promissory note. (3) Accept dilution for that founder. Standard practice is Option 1 with a defined window (e.g., 60 days to cure).

Design Peeps & Ambeego: If They Also Invest Cash

The "Double-Dipping" Question

If Design Peeps (10% sweat equity) also invests, say, $20K cash — do they get *additional* equity on top of their 10%?

Yes — and this is fair. Here's why:

- The 10% compensates **past work** (design deliverables already completed)
- The cash investment compensates **new capital** at current valuation
- These are two separate transactions — just like a CTO with equity who also invests in a round
- The key protection is **vesting** on the sweat equity — if they stop working, unvested shares return

Example Math

Pre-money valuation	$2M (illustrative)
Design Peeps sweat equity	10% (=$200K implied value)
Design Peeps cash investment	$20K (=1% at $2M valuation)
Design Peeps total post-investment	**~11% (10% sweat + 1% cash)**
Ambeego sweat equity	5% (=$100K implied value)
Ambeego cash investment	$10K (=0.5% at $2M valuation)
Ambeego total post-investment	**~5.5% (5% sweat + 0.5% cash)**

Bottom line: Sweat equity = compensation for past work. Cash equity = new investment. They're separate instruments. Vesting on sweat equity + standard investment terms for cash = no double-dipping.

PRODUCT

Design & Dev Work: What's Required

Mapped against the pitch deck targets. Every item ties to a specific KPI we promised investors.

Work Item	Type	Priority	Est. Effort	KPI Impact	Quarter	Design Scope
Analytics instrumentation fix Resolve GA vs verified user gap	Dev	P0	2-3 weeks	Accurate data for all experiments	Q1	None — pure backend
Single-step sign-in + guest mode Reduce 44% pre-Home drop	Both	P0	3-4 weeks	Onboarding drop 70% → <20%	Q1	New sign-in screen, guest flow, progressive signup nudges (3-4 screens)
Direct-to-Home + immediate mood prompt First mood log as "Aha" moment	Both	P0	2-3 weeks	First mood log rate → 50%+	Q1	Simplified Home V2, mood prompt overlay, first-use onboarding (2-3 screens)
Paywall repositioning Move behind "meaningful session"	Both	P0	2 weeks	Trial→paid conversion, churn reduction	Q1-Q2	New paywall screen, contextual upgrade prompts (2-3 variants for A/B)
Mood Tracker 2.0 Context tags + mini-journal	Both	P1	4-5 weeks	% logs with context → 40%+, session duration +20%	Q2	Tag selector UI, mini-journal input, reflection prompts, mood history redesign (5-6 screens)
AI personality system Sage, Blaze, Leo, Grace	Dev	P1	5-6 weeks	AI usage 1.45% → 10%+, PMF 25% → 40%	Q2-Q3	Personality selector, chat UI refinement, typing indicators (3-4 screens)
Home simplification Remove Goals, progressive disclosure	Both	P1	3 weeks	Activation rate, reduced cognitive load	Q2	Full Home screen redesign, card system, bottom nav simplification (3-4 screens)
Performance fixes Blog 20s → <3s, AI latency	Dev	P0	3-4 weeks	Tier-1 churn reduction	Q1-Q2	None — backend optimization
Echo revamp Engagement redesign	Both	P2	4 weeks	Echo engagement 0% → 5%+	Q3	New Echo feed, response UI, notification system (4-5 screens)
Premium features build Voice journals, export, analytics	Both	P2	6-8 weeks	Premium differentiation, conversion	Q3-Q4	Voice recording UI, analytics dashboard, export views (6-8 screens)
Flow-based ads integration Post-session monetization	Dev	P2	2 weeks	Revenue diversification	Q3	Ad placement design, skip/dismiss patterns (1-2 screens)
Widgets (Home screen) Mood log + streak widget	Both	P2	2-3 weeks	DAU, habit formation	Q4	Widget design for iOS + Android (2-3 variants)

~40 weeks
Total dev effort (sequential)
~25 weeks with 2 devs parallel

~35 screens
Total design deliverables
~12 weeks design work (inc. iterations)

6 A/B tests
Required experiments
Onboarding, paywall, mood 2.0, home, AI, Echo

EXECUTION

Quarterly Execution: 18-Month Plan

Q1 2026 (Mar-May)

FIX THE FOUNDATION

Product:
- Analytics instrumentation fix
- Single-step sign-in + guest mode
- Direct-to-Home + mood prompt
- Performance fixes (blog, AI)

Marketing: $3K/mo test budget
Hires: Sr. RN Dev, Mid RN Dev, QA
Equity: Finalize shareholders' agreement

Target: Onboarding <30%

Q2 2026 (Jun-Aug)

ACHIEVE PRODUCT-MARKET FIT

Product:
- Paywall repositioning + A/B test
- Mood Tracker 2.0 launch
- Home simplification
- AI personality system (begin)

Marketing: $8K/mo ramp-up
Hires: Backend Dev, AI/ML Eng, Content
Revenue: 20-30 active paid users

Target: PMF 35%+, D7 4%+

Q3 2026 (Sep-Nov)

SCALE GROWTH ENGINE

Product:
- AI personalities live
- Echo revamp
- Flow-based ads
- Premium features (begin)

Marketing: $15K/mo full push
Hires: UI/UX Designer, Community Mgr
Revenue: 50+ active paid users

Target: PMF 40%+, 25K users

Q4 2026 (Dec-Feb)

MONETIZATION + RETENTION

Product:
- Premium analytics dashboard
- Voice journals + transcription
- Widget ecosystem
- Data export (CSV/PDF)

Marketing: $18K/mo multi-channel
Revenue: 100+ paid, first MRR milestone

Target: 40K users, $2K+ MRR

H1 2027 (Mar-Aug)

SERIES A PREPARATION

Product:
- University partnership integrations
- Multi-language (Arabic, Urdu)
- Wearable integrations
- Advanced AI recommendations

Marketing: $16K/mo optimized
Revenue: 300+ paid, $5K+ MRR

Target: 50K+ users, Series A ready

18-Month Milestones

WHAT WE TELL SERIES A INVESTORS

- **50K+** total users
- **300+** active paid subscribers
- **$5K+** MRR ($60K+ ARR)
- **40%+** PMF score
- **<20%** onboarding drop
- **5-6%** D7 retention
- **LTV:CAC > 3:1** in Tier-1
- **4 AI personalities** live
- **2+ university** partnerships

= Series A at $5-8M valuation

RISKS

Risk Register & Mitigations

HIGH Product fixes don't move PMF

We fix onboarding + paywall but PMF stays <40%. Users still see app as "nice-to-have."

Mitigation: Run rapid A/B tests with 2-week cohort windows. If PMF doesn't move by Q3, pivot feature priority to AI chat depth over breadth.

HIGH Seed round doesn't close at $850K

Investor appetite lower than expected. We raise less or take longer.

Mitigation: Founder bridge funding ($50-100K) to cover Q1-Q2. Lean hiring plan activates only with confirmed capital. $60K contingency reserve in budget.

MED CPI inflation in Tier-1 markets

CPIs rising as more wellness apps enter market. Our $1.80 Tier-1 target may be too optimistic.

Mitigation: Heavy organic/influencer investment (20% of budget). Shift spend to MENA where CPIs are 60% lower. University partnerships as zero-CPI channel.

MED Equity disagreement stalls progress

Design Peeps / Ambeego dispute resolution takes too long or creates founder conflict.

Mitigation: Resolve before seed round closes (hard deadline). Use Option A (vesting) as default. Bring in neutral advisor/lawyer if needed. Budget $18K for legal.

MED Pakistan hiring quality / retention

Top PK devs get poached by Gulf or remote US companies paying 3-5x.

Mitigation: Offer equity grants (0.25-0.5% vesting) to key hires. Pay at 75th percentile for PK market. Emphasize mission-driven culture and career growth.

LOW Guest mode increases anonymous churn

Users stay anonymous, never convert, can't be re-engaged.

Mitigation: Progressive signup nudges after 2 sessions. Gate premium + Echo behind account creation. Track guest→registered conversion rate.

Immediate Next Steps

WEEK 1-2

- Finalize equity resolution
- Sign shareholders' agreement
- Confirm founder cash commitments
- Post Sr. RN Dev job listing

WEEK 3-4

- Begin analytics instrumentation
- Start onboarding redesign
- Set up TikTok Ads account
- Interview dev candidates

MONTH 2-3

- Ship sign-in fix + guest mode
- First paid ad campaigns live
- Measure onboarding improvement
- Begin seed round outreach

We know what's broken. We have the data. We have the plan.

Now we execute.